

Newsletter Audit

Marketing emails, 1 Oct 2025 – 30 Sep 2026 · Source: HubSpot, 8 Oct 2026

3/10

HubSpot email health score

Last 30 days · "Needs work"

3.26%

Click rate

1,028,641 emails sent

0.81%

Unsubscribe rate

+72% vs previous 12 months

1.29%

Hard bounce rate

+97% vs previous 12 months

● What's flagged

Hard bounces: 2.54% in the last 30 days. HubSpot benchmark: 0.25%.

Unsubscribes: 1.04% in the last 30 days. HubSpot benchmark: 0.35%.

3 emails caused 52% of unsubscribes and 79% of bounces of all 97 emails sent 6 Aug – 30 Sep 2026: Japan Sansan list consent mail, Corporate Partnership Survey (3rd batch), Alibaba CoCreate startup email.

Marketing contacts: 590,458, which is 93.7% of the 630,000 tier. 433,657 of them have never opened a marketing email. → Appendix 1

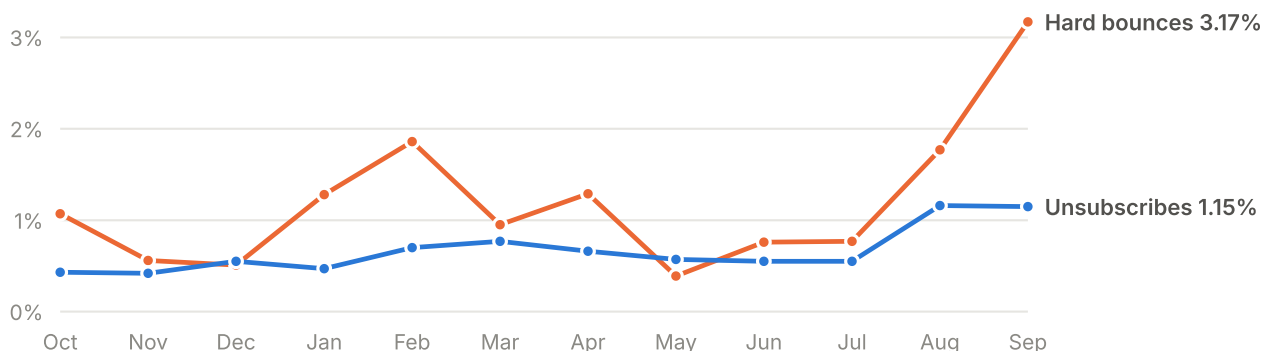
Unsubscribe reasons: no data. The unsubscribe feedback survey is off. → Appendix 3

Teams: none of the 1,042 emails sent has a team assigned. → Appendix 3

Workflows: 65 email workflows are ON and haven't been updated since before 2024. → Appendix 3

Hard bounces and unsubscribes by month (HubSpot Health tab)

Hard bounces Unsubscribes



● What's working

Japan newsletter: 9.6% click rate, 0.05% unsubscribes. Sent every 2 weeks under its own subscription type.

APAC newsletter: 3.0% click rate, under its own subscription type.

Smaller sends: emails to fewer than 300 people averaged an 11.9% click rate and 0.19% unsubscribes. Emails to 5,000+ people averaged 1.4% and 1.56% (6 Aug – 30 Sep).

Spam reports: 0.01%. **Delivery rate:** 98.3%.

"Don't send to unengaged contacts" is switched on.

● What can be improved

UK, Italy and Fintech & AI Insights: the largest newsletters, with click rates of 0.7–1.3% and unsubscribes of 0.96–1.42% per send.

8 location newsletters use the same subscription type ("Marketing Communications"). Contacts can't opt out of just one of them. → [Appendix 2](#)

Engagement: 81,646 of 590,458 marketing contacts (13.8%) opened or clicked an email in the last 12 months. → [Appendix 1](#)

Subscription types: 14 active, 81 archived.

Recurring newsletters, 6 Aug – 30 Sep 2026

Newsletter	Avg. delivered	Click rate	Unsubscribe rate
Fintech & AI Fund Insights	8,611	0.7%	1.42%
Italy Newsletter *	6,624	1.3%	0.96%
UK Newsletter *	6,474	1.1%	0.98%
Global Newsletter (GNL)	5,748	2.4%	0.53%
Texas Newsletter *	4,746	2.9%	0.65%
Startup Autobahn Monthly	4,384	2.1%	0.34%
Central Asia & Caucasus Latest News *	3,302	1.5%	0.76%
APAC Newsletter	2,756	3.0%	0.36%
Seattle Community Newsletter *	1,787	2.2%	0.56%
Indiana Medtech + Lifetech Newsletter *	1,430	1.3%	0.56%
Türkiye Newsletter *	1,420	1.9%	0.56%
Japan Newsletter	989	9.6%	0.05%
Foundation Newsletter	805	0.7%	0.99%
Startup Autobahn Alumni Newsletter	612	0.5%	0.49%
Cyprus Latest News *	309	10.4%	1.94%

Red = above HubSpot's unsubscribe benchmark (0.35%). * = "Marketing Communications" subscription type.

● Possible next steps

- 1 **Imported lists:** validate large imported lists before sending, and send a test batch first.
- 2 **Unsubscribe survey:** switch it on.
- 3 **Inactive contacts:** review the 433,657 marketing contacts who have never opened an email, and decide whether to set them as non-marketing.
- 4 **Subscription types:** give each main location newsletter its own type, as Japan and APAC have.
- 5 **Teams and naming:** assign a team to every email and use one naming format.
- 6 **Workflows:** review the 65 old workflows with their owners.
- 7 **Newsletter owners:** confirm the owner and frequency of each newsletter.
- 8 **Re-check in 90 days:** health score, bounces, unsubscribes and marketing contacts.

Newsletter-level figures cover the 97 emails sent 6 Aug – 30 Sep 2026 (latest 100 records, 3 duplicates removed). All other figures cover 1 Oct 2025 – 30 Sep 2026 or the date shown.

Marketing contacts who don't engage

Measure	Contacts	% of marketing contacts
Marketing contacts (Marketing contact status = Marketing contact)	590,458	100%
Marketing contact tier (Settings > Account & Billing > Usage)	630,000	–
No marketing email open or click in the last 12 months (never opened/clicked included)	508,812	86.2%
Never opened a marketing email	433,657	73.4%
Opened or clicked in the last 12 months	81,646	13.8%

Tier usage: 93.7% used (39,542 contacts left). Next update: 31 Oct 2026. 454 contacts are already scheduled to become non-marketing.

Billing: HubSpot bills by marketing contacts. Non-marketing contacts stay in the CRM and don't count toward the tier ([HubSpot Knowledge Base](#)).

Note: "Never opened" includes contacts added recently.

Source: HubSpot contact counts and Usage page, 8 Oct 2026.

Location newsletters share one subscription type

Email	Sent	From	Subscription type
UK September 2026 Newsletter	30 Sep	Kieran Borrett	Marketing Communications
UK August 2026 Newsletter	2 Sep	Kieran Borrett	Marketing Communications
TEXAS September Newsletter	29 Sep	Francis from Plug and Play	Marketing Communications
TEXAS August Newsletter	26 Aug	Francis from Plug and Play	Marketing Communications
ITA26_Newsletter September	17 Sep	Tommaso Maschera	Marketing Communications
ITA26_Newsletter August	6 Aug	Tommaso Maschera	Marketing Communications
Seattle Community Newsletter (Aug 2026)	1 Sep	Emmanuel Chan	Marketing Communications
Indiana Medtech + Lifetech Newsletter September 2026	18 Sep	Plug and Play Indiana	Marketing Communications
Plug and Play Türkiye August 2026 Newsletter	31 Aug	Zeynep from Plug and Play	Marketing Communications
Plug and Play Cyprus_Latest News_09/26	4 Sep	Victoria (Cyprus)	Marketing Communications
PNPCA_Latest News_ August_2026	4 Sep	Sofi (Central Asia & Caucasus)	Marketing Communications
JAP_Newsletter (4 sends)	Aug-Sep	Plug and Play Japan	Plug and Play Japan
APAC_Newsletter (2 sends)	Aug-Sep	Plug and Play APAC	Plug and Play APAC

Location subscription types in HubSpot

Location	Subscription type	Status
UK	Plug and Play UK Communications	Archived
Texas	Plug and Play Texas	Archived
Italy	Plug and Play Italy (2 types)	Archived
Seattle	Plug and Play Seattle	Archived
Indiana	Plug and Play Indiana	Archived
Türkiye	Plug and Play Istanbul Communications	Archived
Central Asia	Plug and Play Central Asia & Caucasus	Archived
Cyprus	None	–

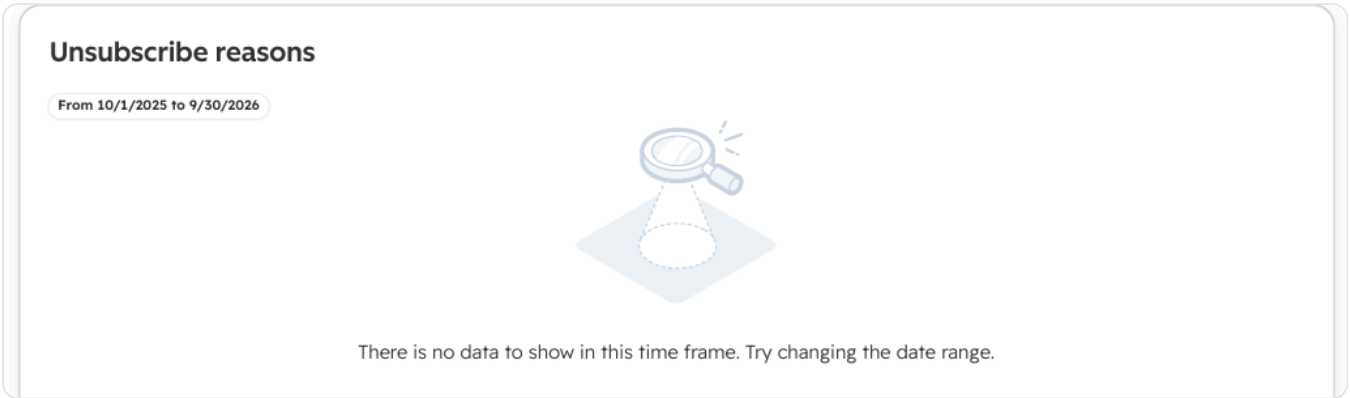
Unsubscribing from "Marketing Communications" stops **every email sent under that type**: these 8 location newsletters and the other emails that use it (32 of the 97 emails sent 6 Aug – 30 Sep).

Other subscription types (e.g. Global Newsletter, Events) are not affected, unless the contact unsubscribes from all.

Source: HubSpot > Marketing > Email and Settings > Marketing > Email > Subscriptions, 8 Oct 2026.

Tracking and automation

Unsubscribe reasons: no data



HubSpot Analyze export, 1 Oct 2025 – 30 Sep 2026. Setting "Unsubscribe feedback survey": OFF.

Teams

None of the 1,042 emails sent has a team assigned. HubSpot has 62 teams set up (e.g. Japan 32 users, Marketing 15, APAC 5, London 3).

Workflows with a "Send email" action

Total	309	
ON	251	
OFF	58	
ON and last updated before 2024 (oldest: 5 Oct 2020)		65
ON, with "COVID" in the name	Last updated	Currently enrolled
JAP_eBook_COVID-19	2024-09-04	0
TVL_Ebook_Rebooting Travel after COVID-19	2023-06-29	0
PNP_World After COVID_Ebook Download	2023-06-29	0
SMC_Ebook_Rethinking Smart Cities after COVID-19	2022-12-27	0
HTH_Ebook_Top Health Startups fighting COVID-19	2021-02-17	0

Full list of the 65 workflows: spreadsheet, tab "Old Workflows". Source: HubSpot > Automation > Workflows, 8 Oct 2026.